4. Explain the following lines with reference to the context.

a) Dear is the Casuarina to my soul;

b) It is the tree's lament, an eerie speech,…

c) Unto thy honor, Tree, beloved of those
Who now in blessed sleep for aye repose,

5. Identify the figure of speech used in each of the extracts given below and write down the answer in the space given below. The first one is done for you.

a) "LIKE a huge Python, winding round and round
The rugged trunk, indented deep with scars",

b) "A creeper climbs, in whose embraces bound
No other tree could live. But gallantly
The giant wears the scarf, and flowers are hung....."

c) "A gray baboon sits statue–like alone"

d) "The water-lilies spring, like snow enmassed."

e) "What is that dirge - like murmur that I hear
Like the sea breaking on a shingle -beach?

a) **Zoomorphism / Simile** b)---------
c)--------- d)--------- e)---------

Zoomorphism
Describing the vine in animal terms (as a python). This is used to illustrate movement, making the tree seem more actively alive and also implying movement. This is a subtle indication of the process of life.

6. Answer each of the following questions in a paragraph of 100–150 words.

a. Describe the reminiscences of the poet, when she sees the casuarina tree.
b) How does nature communicate with the poet?
c) The poet immortalizes the tree. Elucidate.

Listening

First read the questions given below, then listen to the poem, read aloud by the teacher or played on an audio player. Then answer the questions based on your listening of the poem.

1. The poet was tossing in the bed awake because _____.

a) he was worried
b) he was struggling to sleep
c) it was day time
d) he was tired

2. The _____ were 'sparkling as pearls'.

a) moon b) sun
c) stars d) meteoroids

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